UDEMY

Finance & Accounting Course Portfolio

Business Performance Report — Prepared for Stakeholder Review

Executive Summary

The Finance & Accounting portfolio comprises **13,608 courses**, of which **96.4% are paid**. The catalog is performing well ahead of plan: total revenue reached **₹2.37bn**, surpassing the ₹2.00bn target by **18.6%**, while the average course rating of **3.92 / 5** reflects generally strong learner satisfaction across the portfolio.

TOTAL COURSES	PAID COURSES	AVG. RATING	TOTAL REVENUE (+18.6% vs. target)
13,608	13,112	3.92 / 5	₹2.37bn

Performance is uneven across categories: **Business** leads on course volume, but **Big Data** and **Automation** generate disproportionately higher average revenue and subscriber counts on a much smaller catalog footprint — the clearest signal in this report. Pricing and discounting behavior is non-linear: subscriber acquisition responds sharply only to very steep discounts, and both revenue and enrollment spike at a specific premium price point near ₹10K. Course design also matters — shorter, tightly scoped courses out-enroll long-form catalogs — and a small number of critically low-rated courses represent a concentrated reputational risk. Full findings and prioritized recommendations follow.

1. Methodology & Data Preparation

The underlying dataset was cleaned and modeled prior to analysis to ensure reliability of downstream metrics:

- Missing values (**~5%** of records, concentrated in discount-price fields) were reviewed and confirmed to reflect free or non-discounted courses rather than data-entry errors, so they were retained without imputation.
- Redundant text-formatted price columns were excluded from quantitative analysis in favor of their numeric equivalents, and the constant currency field (INR) was dropped as a non-informative variable.
- No duplicate records were detected.
- Date fields were decomposed into creation and publication year/month components, and a category hierarchy (category → course title) was built to support portfolio-level analysis.
- Two custom measures were derived to enable financial analysis: an **Estimated Revenue** metric (subscribers × effective price) and a **Discount Percentage** metric (list price vs. discounted price), alongside supporting totals for course counts and paid-course counts.

2. Portfolio Overview

The portfolio dashboard below summarizes headline volume, quality, and revenue performance, alongside publication growth and category concentration.

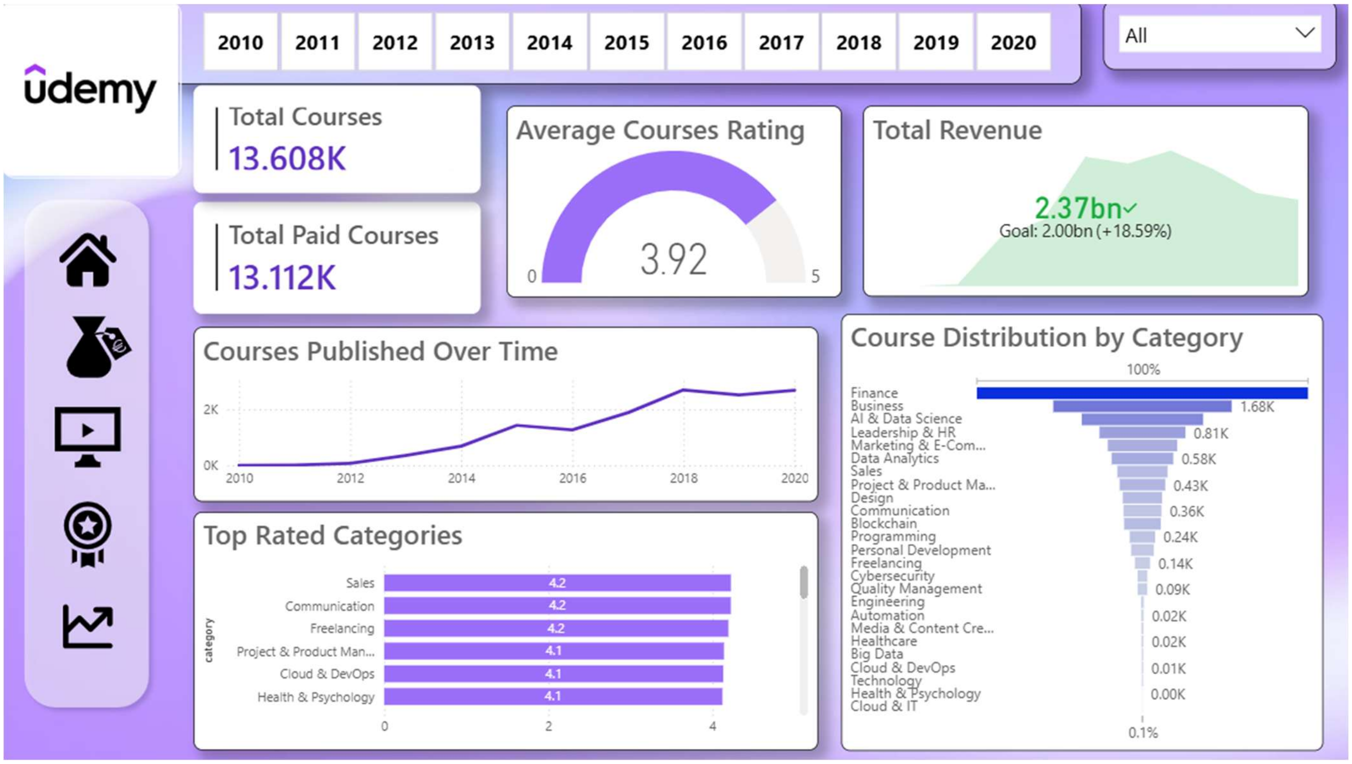

Figure 1 — Portfolio KPIs, publication growth, and category distribution

2.1 Headline Performance

- **Scale:** the platform hosts 13,608 courses in this domain, with paid offerings making up the overwhelming majority (13,112), confirming a monetization-first catalog strategy.
- **Satisfaction:** an average rating of 3.92/5 indicates a generally positive learner reception across a large and varied catalog.
- **Financial performance:** total revenue of ₹2.37bn exceeded the ₹2.00bn target by 18.6%, indicating the category is financially healthy and outperforming expectations.

2.2 Growth Trajectory

- Publication volume grew slowly from 2010–2013, then accelerated sharply from 2014–2015 onward, plateauing at a materially higher annual output from 2018 through 2020.
- This pattern is consistent with a deliberate scale-up phase in content production rather than organic, unmanaged growth.

2.3 Category Concentration

- **Business** leads catalog volume (1.68K courses), followed by **Leadership & HR** (0.81K) and **Data Analytics** (0.58K).
- A long tail of niche categories — Cloud & DevOps, Technology, Health & Psychology, and Cloud & IT — contribute comparatively few courses, representing either genuine niche demand or untapped catalog gaps.

3. Category Performance

Course volume alone is a poor proxy for category value. Viewed alongside revenue, subscriber, and rating data, a different set of categories emerges as the true performance leaders.

3.1 Revenue by Category

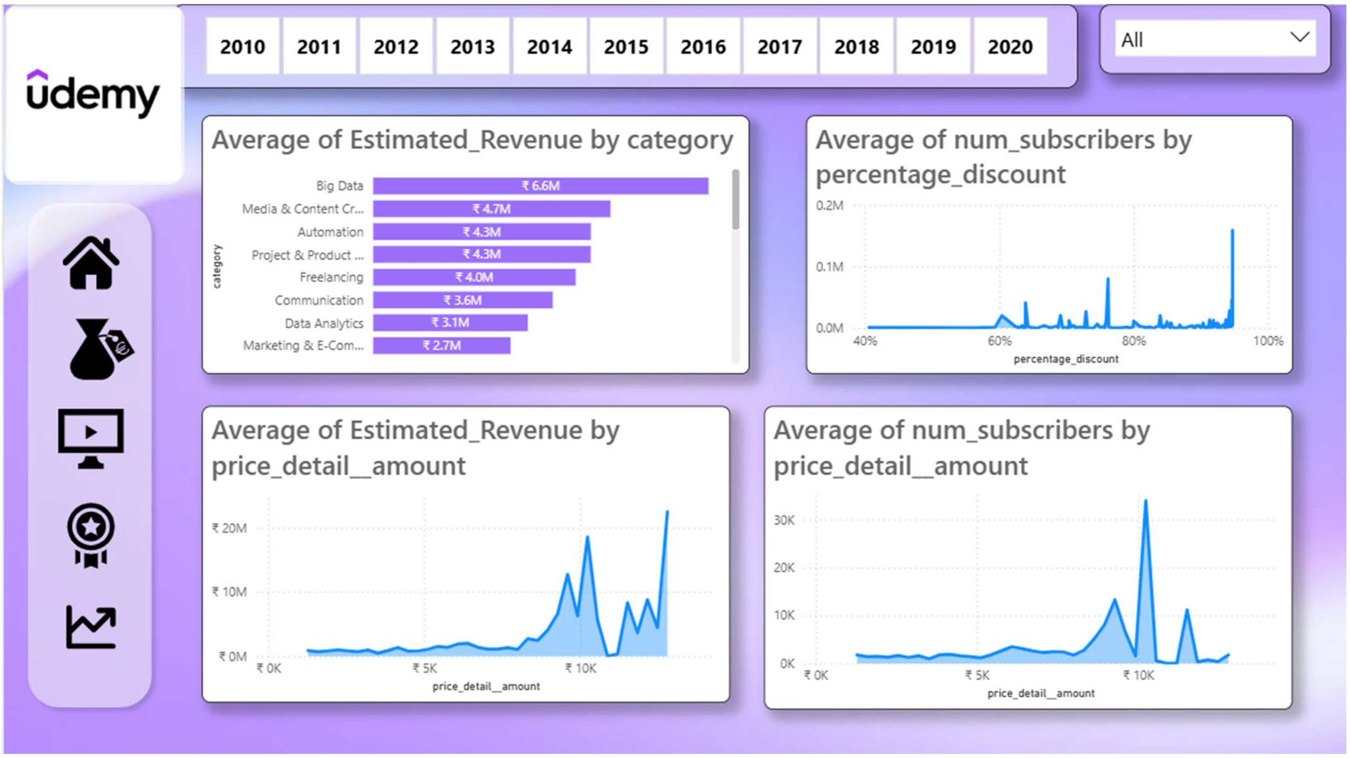

Figure 2 — Revenue and subscriber sensitivity to discounting and price

- **Big Data** generates the highest average estimated revenue by a wide margin, well ahead of every other category.
- **Media & Content Creation, Automation**, and **Project & Product Management** form a strong upper-middle tier, averaging ₹4M–₹5M in revenue.
- Freelancing, Communication, and Data Analytics generate lower average revenue (below ₹4M) despite carrying substantial course volume — a sign of potential pricing or monetization inefficiency in otherwise popular categories.

3.2 Subscriber Volume by Category

- **Big Data** also leads decisively on total subscriptions (14.6K), followed by **Automation** (9.2K) and **Data Analytics** (6.0K).
- Business — despite the largest course count — ranks comparatively low on subscribers per category (3.7K), reinforcing that high catalog volume is not translating into proportionate demand.

3.3 Rating Quality by Category

- Sales, Communication, Freelancing, Project & Product Management, Cloud & DevOps, Health & Psychology, and Leadership & HR post the strongest average ratings, showing that high learner satisfaction is achievable independent of category size.

4. Pricing & Discount Strategy

4.1 Discount Sensitivity

- Subscriber volume stays flat and low across moderate discount levels (40–70%), indicating limited return on mid-range promotional pricing.
- A pronounced spike in subscriber acquisition occurs only at extreme discount levels (approaching 95–100%), suggesting deep, infrequent promotions are far more effective demand triggers than routine moderate discounting.

4.2 Price Point vs. Revenue and Subscribers

- Revenue stays minimal and flat for courses priced under ₹5K, then becomes highly volatile with sharp peaks as list price passes ₹10K.
- Subscriber volume follows a closely correlated pattern, with a distinct peak at approximately the ₹10K price point before tapering at higher price extremes.
- Together, these patterns suggest a specific premium price band — not simply "higher price" — is capturing outsized value, and warrants direct investigation into which courses and categories occupy it.

5. Course Design & Engagement Factors

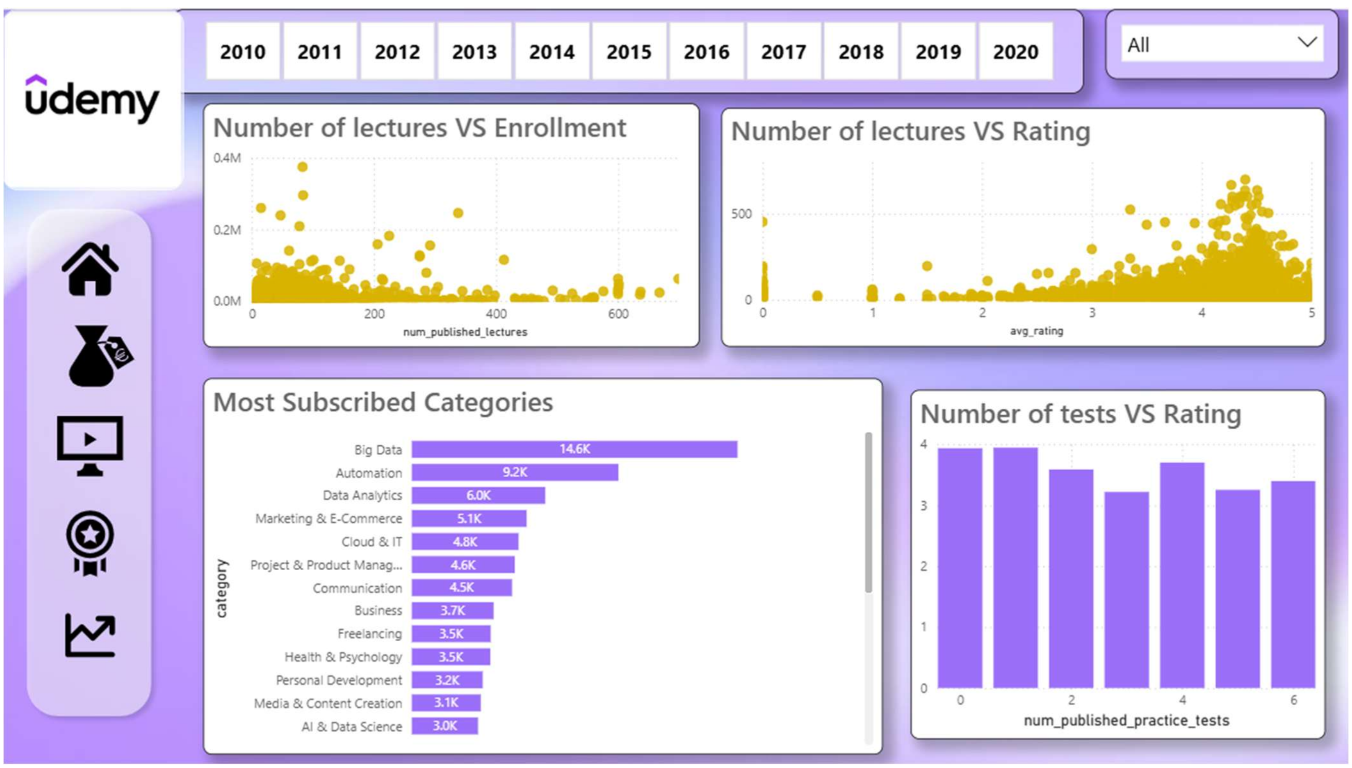

Figure 3 — Lecture count, rating, and engagement relationships

5.1 Lecture Count vs. Enrollment

- The highest-enrollment courses (peaking near 0.4M subscribers) cluster in a lower-to-moderate lecture range, typically under 200 lectures.
- Courses with very high lecture counts (400–600+) show consistently compressed enrollment — longer is not automatically better from a demand standpoint.

5.2 Lecture Count vs. Rating

- The large majority of courses maintain ratings between 4.0 and 5.0 regardless of lecture count, suggesting course length has little bearing on perceived quality.

5.3 Practice Tests vs. Rating

- Average ratings remain stable (roughly 3.2–4.0) regardless of whether a course includes 0, 2, 4, or 6 practice tests, indicating practice tests are a supporting feature rather than a primary driver of course quality perception.

6. Quality Assurance & Course Health

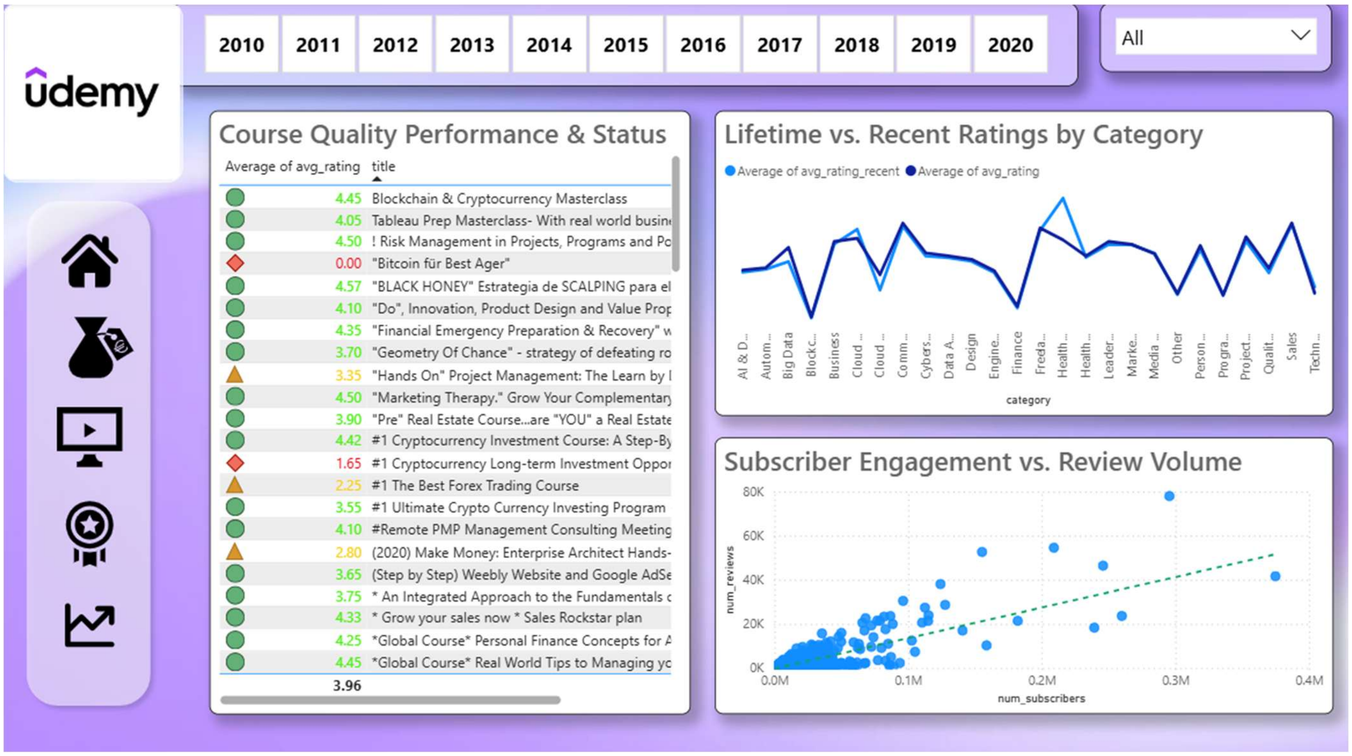

Figure 4 — Course-level quality status, rating trends, and engagement correlation

6.1 Course-Level Quality Flags

- A course-level status view (green / amber / red) flags individual titles for review. Strong performers include **"Risk Management in Projects"** (4.50) and **"Blockchain & Cryptocurrency Masterclass"** (4.45).
- Several titles are flagged red for critically low ratings, notably **"Bitcoin für Best Ager"** (0.00) and **"#1 Cryptocurrency Long-term Investment Opportunity"** (1.65) — clear candidates for content review, rework, or removal.

6.2 Lifetime vs. Recent Ratings

- Recent and lifetime rating trends track closely across most categories, indicating long-term stability in learner satisfaction rather than volatility.
- Health & Psychology shows the most notable positive shift: a recent average rating of **4.38** versus a lifetime average of **4.12** — a 0.26-point improvement suggesting recent content or instructor changes are resonating well with learners.

6.3 Subscriber Engagement vs. Reviews

- Subscribers and review counts are positively and linearly correlated, as expected.
- A small set of high-performing outliers scale past 0.3M–0.4M subscribers and generate 40K–80K reviews, representing the portfolio's flagship titles and a useful benchmark for what “success” looks like at scale.

7. Publication Trends & Seasonality

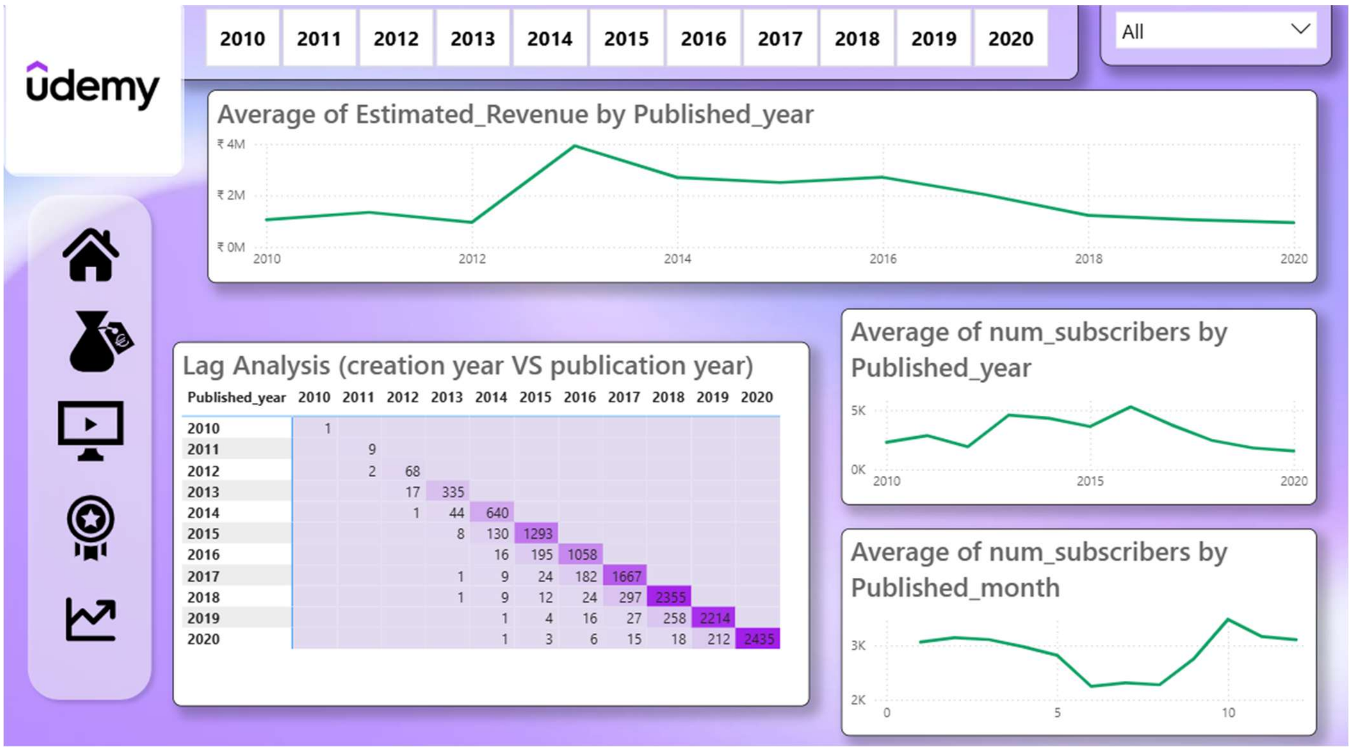

Figure 5 — Revenue by publication year, content lag, and seasonal subscriber patterns

7.1 Revenue by Publication Year

- Average revenue per course rose sharply to a peak around 2015, then gradually declined and stabilized through 2018–2020 — worth monitoring as a potential sign of category maturation or increased competition.

7.2 Content Pipeline Lag

- Creation and publication years align closely for the large majority of courses (e.g., 2,435 courses created and published in 2020 alone), showing a fast, efficient content pipeline with minimal backlog.

7.3 Seasonality

- Subscriber acquisition is stable from January through April, dips mid-year (May–August), then rises sharply to a clear peak in October before settling into late-year stability — a predictable seasonal window for launch and marketing planning.

8. Recommendations

Based on the findings above, the following actions are recommended, ordered by expected business impact:

Priority	Recommendation	Why it matters
HIGH	**Prioritize instructor acquisition and marketing spend in Big Data, Automation and Data Analytics.**	These categories generate the highest average revenue and subscriber volume per course despite modest catalog share — the clearest return on incremental content investment.
HIGH	**Establish a quarterly quality-review process to flag and remediate or delist courses with critically low ratings.**	Titles such as “Bitcoin für Best Ager” (0.00) and “#1 Cryptocurrency Long-term Investment Opportunity” (1.65) actively erode trust and pull down category averages.
MEDIUM	**Re-evaluate blanket steep discounting (90–100%) and test whether it is driving genuine long-term subscribers or one-time signups.**	Subscriber acquisition spikes sharply only at extreme discount levels; moderate discounts (40–70%) show little to no incremental effect and may be compressing margin unnecessarily.
MEDIUM	**Study the pricing and content profile of courses clustered near the ₹10K mark and use them as a template for premium offerings.**	This price band shows a disproportionate spike in both revenue and subscribers, suggesting a well-received premium positioning that is not yet systematically replicated.
MEDIUM	**Issue instructor guidance favoring concise, tightly scoped courses (broadly under ~200 lectures) over long-form catalogs.**	Enrollment is heavily concentrated in shorter courses; very long courses (400–600+ lectures) see materially lower enrollment, indicating diminishing returns on course length.
LOW	**Concentrate major launches and promotional campaigns around September–October.**	Subscriber acquisition shows a consistent seasonal peak in October, presenting a predictable window to time releases and marketing spend for maximum impact.
LOW	**Maintain current pricing and enterprise upsell strategy, but monitor the post-2015 decline in average per-course revenue.**	Overall revenue is 18.6% ahead of target, but average revenue per course has trended down since its 2015 peak — worth tracking to confirm this reflects portfolio growth rather than saturation.

In summary, the portfolio is financially healthy and outperforming target, but future growth is likely to come less from adding volume to already-large categories such as Business, and more from deliberately scaling proven high-yield categories, protecting catalog quality, and applying pricing and seasonal timing strategies that the data shows are already working.